INCH POUNG
A-A-243B
February 6, 1995
SUPERSEDING
A-A-243A
June 29, 1984

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SHEARS; PRUNING (TWO HAND, LOPPING)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description (CID), for all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This commercial item description covers two hand operated pruning shears capable of lopping small diameter tree branches.

2. CLASSIFICATION

2.1 Classification. The shears shall be of the following types and sizes, as specified (see 7.2):

Type I - Wooden handle shears

Type II - Shears with handles other than wood

Size 1 - 24 inch Length (61.8 cm), Minimum Cutting Capacity 1-1/2 inches (3.8 cm)
Size 2 - 27 inch Length (68.6 cm), Minimum Cutting Capacity 1-5/8 inches (4.1 cm)
Size 3 - 30 inch Length (76.2 cm), Minimum Cutting Capacity 2 inches (5.1 cm)

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

3.1 Type 1, Wooden handle shears. The type I lopping shears shall be provided with straight grain hardwood handles. The handles shall be smoothly finished to provide comfortable hand grips. A clear varnish, lacquer, shellac, polyurethane, or samilar coating shall completely cover the handles to prevent absorption of water. The type I shears shall be similar in design to figure 1.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: General Services Administration, Engineering Group (7FXEE), 819 Taylor St., Fort Worth, TX 76102

FSC 3750

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3.1.1 Ferrules. The type I- shears shall have the wooden handles securely anchored in seamless steel ferrules with metal end caps to prevent loosening, cracking, or deformation when the shears are operated. The ferrule and cap shall be plated or painted to prevent corrosion. A metal fastening device such as a bolt shall be provided in each handle. The fastener shall pass through the ferrule, handle, and cutting head tang to secure the handle in the ferrule and secure the cutting head tang into the handle.

3.2 Type II, Shears with handle's other than wood. Type II shears shall have handles made from tubular steel, aluminum, or fiberglass. Handles made from non-corrosion resistant material shall be plated to prevent corrosion. Metal handles shall be provided with permanently affixed hand grips, manufactured from non-conductive material. The type II shears shall be similar in design to figure 2.

3.3 Cutting head. The cutting head shall consist of a convex blade and a concave hook. The blade shall have a ground and keen cutting edge. The cutting head assembly shall be constructed from high carbon steel or alloy steel having a minimum thickness of 5/32 inch (4.0 mm) . The cutting head, including the tangs shall have a hardness of not less than 46 nor more than 58 on the Rockwell "C" scale when tested in accordance with ASTM E 18. The overall length of the cutting head assembly in the closed position shall be 8-1/2 inches ± 1/2 inch (21.6 cm ± 1.2 cm) when measured along a centerline between the tangs to the tip of the cutting head. The cutting head tangs shall extend a minimum of 2-1/2 inches (6.4 cm) into the handle.

3.4 Pivot Bolt. The pivot bolt for the cutting head shall be hardened to withstand normal use and shall have a minimum diameter of 3/8 inch (9.5 mm). A friction type locking fastener shall be provided at the pivot bolt to prevent loss of tension during normal usage .

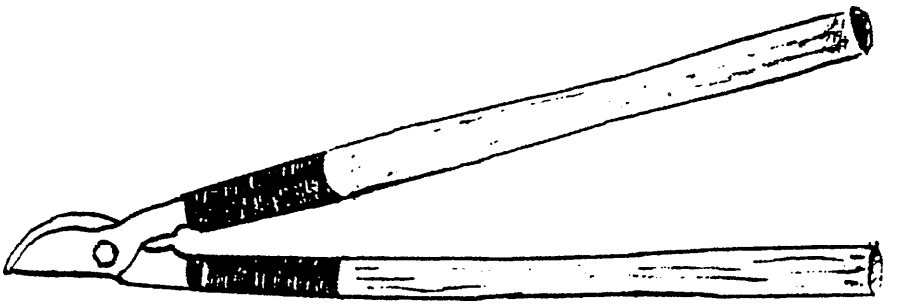

Figure 1 - Type I Shears

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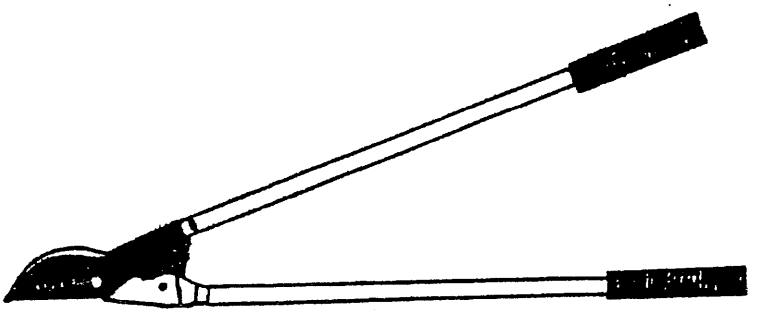

Figure 2 - Type II Shears

3.5 Operation. The pruning shears shall be designed for two hand operation. The closing of the shears shall be limited by means of either integral or external stop(s) .

3.6 Finish. The cutting blade and hook shall have a permanently applied corrosion resistant finish. The finish shall be chrome plating, black oxide, or a teflon-type (polytetrafluoroethylene) coating to prevent corrosion and debris build-up. The sharpened edge of the blade shall not be coated.

3.7 Performance. The shears shall be capable of cleanly cutting, one at a time, fifteen branches of green hardwood of the specified diameter (cutting capacity) l The size 1 shears shall be capable of cutting branches 1-1/2 inches (3.8 cm) in diameter. The size 2 shears shall be capable of cutting branches 1-5/8 inches (4.1 cm) in diameter. The size 3 shears shall be capable of cutting branches 2 inches (5.1 cm) in diameter. Each cut shall be made in one “bite*’ without splintering the wood or breaking, bending, or showing signs of distortion or damage to any part of the shears. The shears shall show no evidence of vegetation or debris build-up between the blade and hook. Additionally, the shears shall show no distortion of the cutting head, loosening, or bending of the handles or other signs of damage after the cutting operation.

3.8 Identification marking. The shears shall be marked with the manufacturer’s name or trademark. The use of an adhesive--backed label shall be acceptable.

3.9 Workmanship. The shears shall be free from defects which will impair the serviceability, durability or appearance of the shears. The shears shall be smoothly finished, true to shape, and show no evidence of misalignment. The operation or handling of the shears shall not be injurious to personnel.

3.10 Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within tolerances specified and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

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3.11 Standard commercial product. The shears shall, as a minimum, be in accordance with the requirements of this CID and shall be the manufacturer's standard commercial product. A currently offered product is a product which has been sold or is for sale on the commercial market through advertisements, manufacturer's catalogs, or brochures, and represents the latest" production model.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS

4.1 Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

5.1 Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications standards and quality assurance practices, and is . the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

6. PACKAGING

6.2 Preservation, packing, and marking. preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. NOTES

7.1 Sources of non-Government association documents.

ASTM standards are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) , 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

7.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents (if applicable).

a. Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
b. Type and size required (see 2.1) .
c. Preservation, packing, and marking required.

7.3 Figures. The figures shown herein are descriptive and not restrictive, and not intended to preclude the purchase of items which are otherwise in accordance with the requirements of this commercial item description.

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